

PRODUCT BRIEF · AUGUST 2026

The family safety app that doesn't feel like surveillance.

Nestly gives parents location, screen time and safety alerts across three surfaces — a parent phone app, a managed child device and a web dashboard — while showing the child exactly what is shared. Free for the first two children, so households can adopt it before they pay for it.



2 real devices

Parent and child, paired over Bluetooth

Works offline

Routines enforced on the child's phone

Android build

Signed APK, sideload-ready today

THE PROBLEM

Parents are handed a binary choice: spy, or hope.

The category splits cleanly in two, and neither half fits an ordinary household. On one side sit heavyweight monitoring tools built around covert capture — message interception, keystroke logs, screen recording. They work, and they cost the parent the relationship.

On the other sit the built-in platform controls: trustworthy, and far too blunt. A daily minute budget cannot tell a maths app at 4pm from a game at 4pm, and it collapses the moment a child's phone is on a different platform to their parent's.

The tell is what parents actually ask first. Not "can I see everything?" but "will my child know?" — a question neither half of the market answers well.

What breaks in practice

- **Rules that ignore context.** A screen-time cap doesn't know it's a school day.
- **Enforcement that needs signal.** Limits lift the moment the phone drops offline.
- **Alerts without triage.** A wall of notifications trains parents to ignore all of them.
- **Nothing for the child.** The supervised person has no view of what is collected.
- **Priced per household, up front.** Families pay before they trust it.

THE PRODUCT

Three surfaces, one household

Parent app

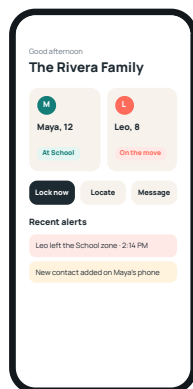
Phone-first. Home, live map and geofences, screen-time scenarios, activity and web filtering, a triaged alerts feed, encrypted family chat, and weekly guidance.

Child device

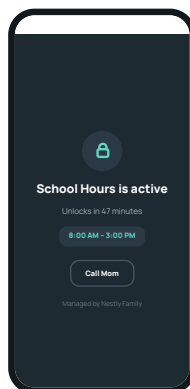
Deliberately two screens. A lock screen that says which routine is running and when it lifts, and a transparency notice listing exactly what is shared.

Web dashboard

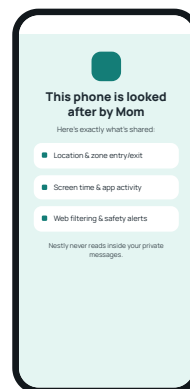
For a desk rather than a pocket. Both children side by side, a map that keeps the live activity feed in view, and plan management.



Parent app — Home



Child device — Lock screen



Child device — Transparency

Four decisions competitors haven't copied

Scenarios, not minute budgets

Rules are named routines — School Hours, Lunch, Piano Lesson, Church — each with its own days, window and block list. Parents reason about their week, not about a number, and the same vocabulary works for a seven-year-old and a sixteen-year-old.

Enforcement that survives offline

A scenario is evaluated on the device against a locally-held schedule. Turning off mobile data, the oldest trick there is, does not lift the limit. Most competitors enforce server-side and quietly fail open.

Acoustic safety alerts

On-device audio classification flags distress patterns — a scream, panic — and surfaces one triaged alert with a confidence score, a location and two actions: call, or mark false alarm. No audio leaves the device and nothing is recorded.

Transparency as a feature

The child sees a plain list of everything shared, and private message content is explicitly excluded. This is the answer to the objection that stops most sign-ups, and it is very hard for a covert-capture competitor to copy without repudiating their own product.

BUSINESS MODEL

Free until the family is bought in

Family plan

1 parent + 2 children

£0

- Location & geofences
- Screen time & scenarios
- Web filtering
- Acoustic safety alerts
- Full activity history

Additional children

Third child and up

£3.99 /mo each

or £34/yr — a 25% saving

- Identical feature set
- Billed per additional child
- Add or remove any time

The logic

Two free children covers most of the market outright, which removes price as a reason not to try it and buys distribution through the cheapest channel there is — one parent telling another at the school gate.

Revenue then comes from larger families, who are also the households under the most logistical strain and the least likely to churn. The upgrade moment is a real event — a third child getting a phone — rather than an arbitrary paywall.

Billing is web-only, which keeps app-store commission off the subscription line entirely.

Built, running, and installable today

Done

- Two real devices. A single install becomes a parent phone or a child phone and the pair links directly over Bluetooth LE — no account, no server, nothing to sign up for.
- An autonomous child agent: samples real location, evaluates geofences on-device, decides which routine is active, and logs every transition durably.
- Store-and-forward sync. The child keeps working out of range and hands its backlog over when the phones next meet, so distance costs latency rather than history.
- Android application packaged with Capacitor 6, release-signed and sideload-ready, including a custom BLE-peripheral plugin and foreground service.

Next, in order

- **Hardware validation.** The link is covered by tests end to end, but the radio itself needs two Android handsets before any pilot.
- **Online service.** Accounts and real-time sync, so a parent sees their child while they are apart. The transport is already an interface with two implementations behind it.
- **Device policy.** Android Device Owner enrolment — what turns today's soft lock screen into limits a child cannot step around.
- **Acoustic model.** On-device classifier behind the alert flow that is already built.
- **iOS.** The Capacitor project is structured for it; the parent app first.

Technical shape

App	React 18 + TypeScript + Tailwind
Native shell	Capacitor 6 (Android; iOS ready)
Device link	Bluetooth LE, custom peripheral plugin
Target	compileSdk 34, minSdk 22
Offline	Rules enforced on-device; no network needed
Distribution	Release-signed APK; Play-ready

MARKET SIZING — TO COMPLETE

Insert your own TAM/SAM/SOM for households with school-age children in the launch geography, with the source. Deliberately left blank rather than estimated.

TRACTION & PIPELINE — TO COMPLETE

Insert waitlist numbers, pilot schools, letters of intent or early install figures once they exist.

THE ASK

What we're looking for

Introductions to schools and parent networks for a pilot cohort, and partners on the device-policy and on-device-audio work. The product is far enough along that the next useful input is real households, not more design.

